



Gaining levels: Sustaining the momentum will be the biggest challenge for the club when it embarks on the more difficult job of excelling in the I-League.

provide the knowledge base that comes with his long association with football at the highest level. “The club was conceived with the idea of providing the right platform for excellence to the young players from within and outside the state. Everything was done with an open mind in order to facilitate the improvement of the infrastructure in the state. There was no scope for any narrowness that would bring political, religious or regional affiliations into consideration,” says Bhattacharya while explaining the ethos behind the club’s foundation.

The club’s rapid rise is the result of a professional approach in the management of its affairs. “Every aspect of the club management is in the hands of professionals. This can be gauged from the decision of having a highly successful Kibu

Vicuna as the head coach. The Spanish coach has a good understanding of Indian football, as he had secured the I-League title for Mohun Bagan barely a couple of years ago,” Bhattacharya said.

“The team started performing quite well from the very start as we reached the top tier of the local league (CFL Premier Division) after finishing second in the First Division, where we started our journey. Next, we did well in the I-League 3 and took a step further in becoming the I-League 2 champion while remaining unbeaten in the whole tournament,” he added.

A football club requires a dedicated fan base to ensure its survival, and Diamond Harbour FC is already garnering a lot of support among the population in the port town on the southern fringes of the state from which the club draws its name. “The legacy clubs like East Bengal or Mohun Bagan have a huge support base due to their presence for over a century. We are working with around three hundred clubs in the Diamond Harbour region to

Meteoric rise



2022

Club founded on April 15.

2022–23

Debuts in the CFL First Division. Finishes second in the final league standings, earning promotion to the CFL Premier Division.

2023–24

Finishes third in the CFL Premier Division and qualifies for I-League 3. Later secures promotion to I-League 2 in 2024.

2024–25

Wins the I-League 2 title with an unbeaten record.

Also delivers a strong performance in the CFL Premier Division, remaining unbeaten until the final two matches — both suspended due to a legal dispute. The tournament remains inconclusive.

Across all competitions, the team played 40 official matches during the season and lost only once.